

11.2 Copyright And Piracy

Copyright is the authority given to an artist over the commercial exploitation of his art. Usually this is for a fixed duration, after which the content enters the Public Domain where it is free and can be used by anyone.

Copyright violation, or piracy, is a major issue for online media distribution. Briefly, it is illegal to download copyrighted content without the proper permission. With the spread of peer-to-peer networks that operate without a central server, it has become easier to distribute and access content that one has no copyright over. While it is easy to come across such content, the user needs to be aware of the consequences of such action. Similar to theft, copyright violation is a punishable offence.

11.3 Content Sites

Sites offering streaming content are easier to find than sites offering downloads. The reason for this is obvious once you view a stream: ads. Many sites offer free downloads of English songs and videos that are in the public domain. It is hard to come across legitimate sites offering similar Indian content.

Streaming content also comes in the form of radio stations and TV channels. Online TV stations can be accessed by using applications like TV.exe (tvexe.com), which is based on WMP and comes preloaded with a selection of TV channels. Alternatively, they can be accessed just like other streaming content, by using media players. Sites like WWiTV.com list links to IPTV channels from all over the world. Selecting a link launches the associated media player, and you can watch the channel. Similarly, Internet radio stations are also accessible through the many sites that index such stations. A few sites that offer free content are mentioned next. This is not an exhaustive list.